

Egg to adult

The one thing insects are very, very good at is making more insects. They all start off as eggs, then grow up in lots of strange and different ways.

Metamorphosis

When they're born, many insects look nothing like their parents. They have to go through three stages – egg, larva, and pupa – before they become adults. This process is called metamorphosis.

Dragonflies have to shed their outer skin in order to grow.

Every insect in the world lays eggs.



Stages 1 and 2: egg and larva

The butterfly lays her eggs and they hatch into larvae. The larva of a butterfly is called a caterpillar. It eats and eats enough leaves until it gets fat.

Small changes

Some insects are born only a little different from their parents. With dragonflies, the main difference is that their babies live completely under water; as the babies grow, they develop air tubes for breathing air, and wings for flying.

Turn and learn

Butterflies:
pp. 118-119
Beetles:
pp. 120-121